CSE0001

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Digital Literacy & Professional Identity: A Student Ambassador Portfolio

SUBMITTED BY: TANISHKA SAHU

REGISTRATION NO.: 25BCE10056

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Design Concept & Objective

For this task, I acted as a Student Digital Ambassador to design a one-page infographic using **Canva**. The primary objective was to create a resource that defines digital literacy for engineering students while promoting safe and professional internet habits. The design focuses on three core pillars:

1. **Critical Thinking:** Evaluating online information.
2. **Cyber Hygiene:** Practicing safe habits like UPI security.
3. **Digital Footprint:** Maintaining a professional online presence.

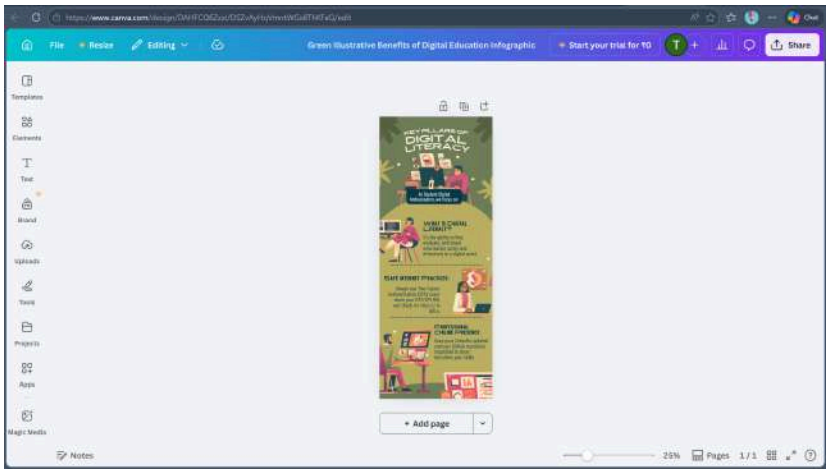
Visual Communication Strategy

I chose a modern, high-contrast layout with clear iconography to ensure the information is accessible and engaging for my batchmates. One of the most significant challenges was establishing a strong **'Visual Hierarchy'**. I had to decide which data points were most critical to highlight first. I realized that while technical skills are important, immediate safety concerns—such as **UPI Fraud prevention**—needed the most visual prominence to capture attention quickly.

Key Reflection

The most difficult part of this process was condensing broad, complex topics like 'Global Cybersecurity' into three simple, actionable bullet points. This exercise taught me that effective digital communication requires a delicate balance between being thorough and being concise. By using a **"Z-pattern" layout** and strategic typography, I ensured that the most vital information was scannable, demonstrating how design can be used to educate and protect a digital community.

Work in progress



KEY PILLARS OF
DIGITAL
LITERACY
As Student Digital Ambassadors, we focus on:
WHAT IS DIGITAL LITERACY?
It's the ability to find, evaluate, and share information safely and effectively in a digital world.
SAFE INTERNET PRACTICES:
Always use Two-Factor Authentication (2FA), never share your OTP/UPI PIN, and check for https:// in URLs.
PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE
Keep your LinkedIn updated and your GitHub repository organized to show recruiters your skills
IA

Task 2: Building a Student Digital Portfolio

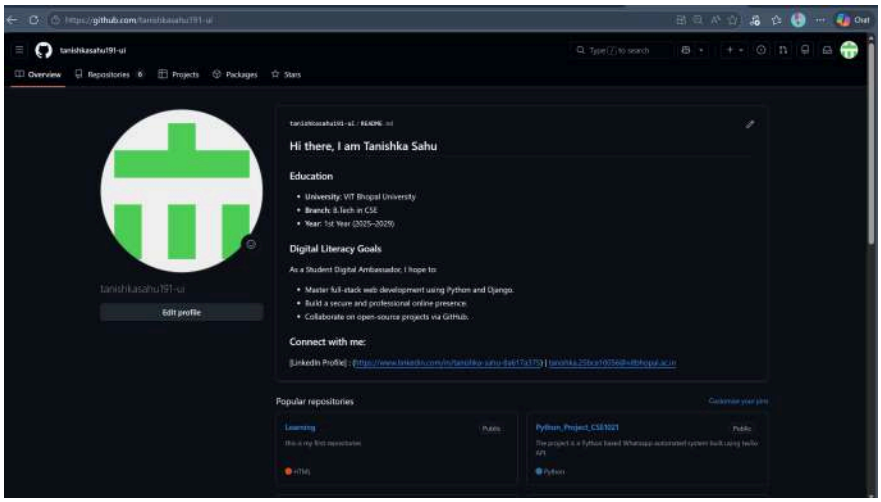
Professional Identity & Platform Selection

For this task, I established a foundational digital presence across three primary platforms: **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow**. I chose these specific platforms because they represent the essential 'digital footprint' for a modern engineering student. While LinkedIn serves as my professional networking hub, GitHub acts as my technical resume, and Stack Overflow provides a platform for collaborative problem-solving within the global developer community.

Platform Implementation

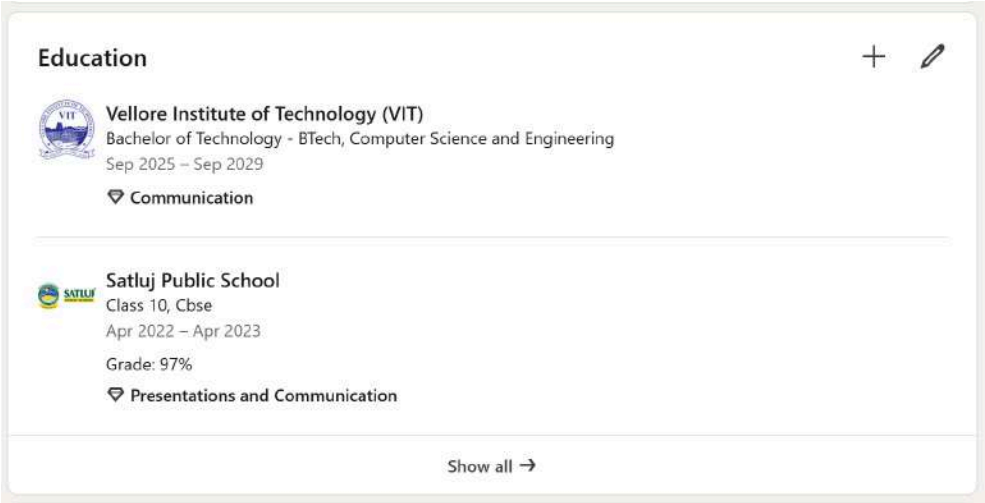
- **GitHub:** I created a specialized **Profile README** to introduce myself, my technical interests, and my academic goals. This allows me to showcase my projects and coding consistency to the open-source community.

Github profile



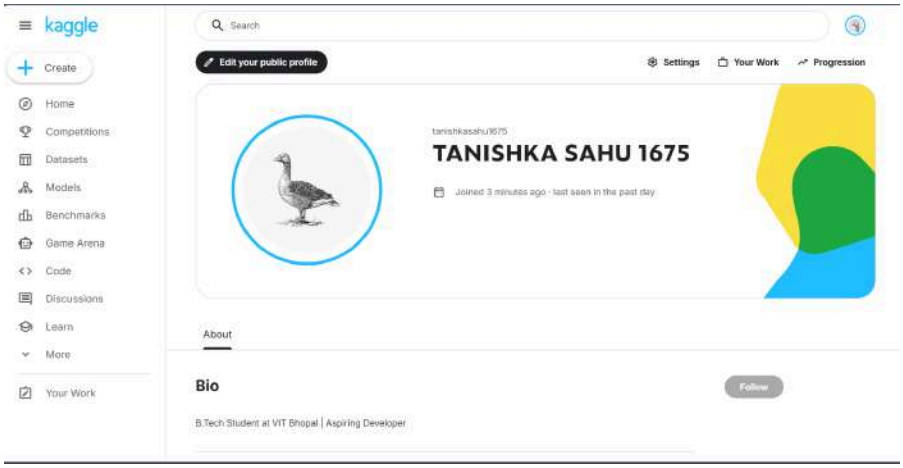
- **LinkedIn:** I formalized my professional status by detailing my enrollment at **VIT Bhopal University**. I optimized my profile to ensure that my academic milestones are visible to recruiters and industry professionals.

LinkedIn profile education section



- **Technical Community:** By setting up a professional account on a third platform (Stack Overflow/Kaggle), I have positioned myself to engage in peer-to-peer learning and technical troubleshooting.

Kaggle profile page



Key Reflection

Setting these platforms up helped me realize that a professional digital presence is an ongoing project, not a one-time task. The most significant takeaway was learning how these platforms interlink—for instance, my GitHub repositories can be highlighted on LinkedIn to provide evidence of my technical competence. Over the next four years, I plan to use these tools to document my journey in Computer Science, contribute to meaningful projects, and build a network that extends beyond the classroom.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms.

Part A: Technical Skill Building (HackerRank)

In the first part of this task, I utilized **HackerRank**, a leading technical assessment platform, to complete a beginner-level coding challenge. As a B.Tech student, engaging with competitive programming platforms is essential for developing problem-solving skills and algorithmic thinking.

Challenge Completed: ‘Solve Me First' or print 'Hello World’

Outcome: Successfully passed all test cases and earned the initial platform badges. This exercise familiarized me with the environment used by top tech companies for technical recruitment, highlighting the importance of clean, efficient code.

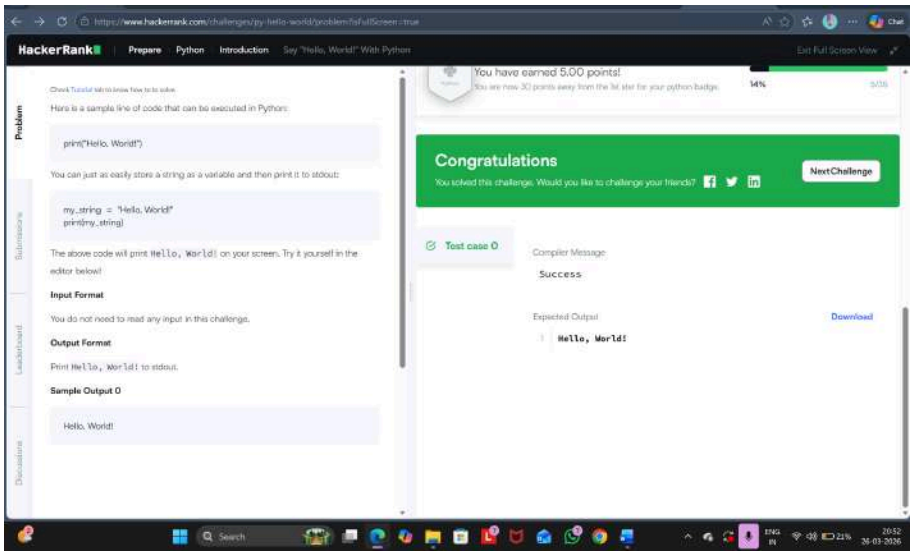
Part B: Digital Collaboration (Google Forms & Sheets)

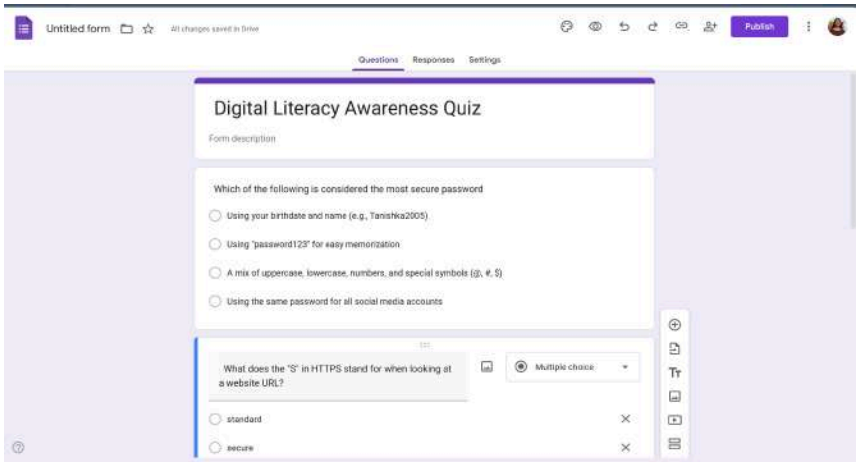
For the collaboration component, I acted as a Student Digital Ambassador to design and deploy a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using Google Forms.

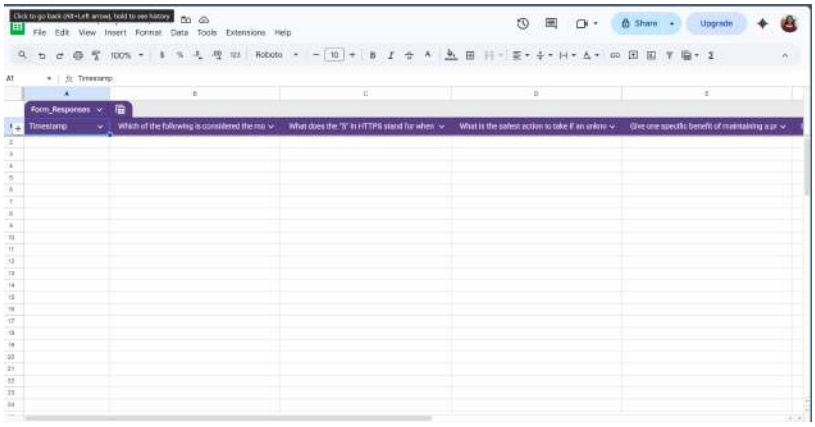
- **Platform Logic:** I developed a 5-question quiz designed to test my peers on topics such as UPI safety, phishing identification, and password hygiene.

- **Data Automation:** I linked the form to a **Google Sheet** to automate the collection and analysis of responses in real-time.

Key Learning: This exercise demonstrated the power of cloud-based collaborative tools. I learned that digital literacy is not just about individual skill, but about creating systems like automated quizzes that help educate and gather data from a larger community efficiently. The most interesting challenge was crafting questions that were technically accurate yet easy for non-technical users to understand.







Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide.

One significant situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem involved a student who sent a casual, poorly structured email to a potential internship coordinator.

The student used an unprofessional email address, omitted a subject line, and used 'text-speak' in the body of the message. As a result, the coordinator dismissed the application immediately, assuming the student lacked the professionalism required for the workplace.

To avoid this, the student should have used a formal college email ID and a clear subject line like 'Internship Inquiry . A professional greeting and a structured sign-off would have signaled respect and competence. This scenario highlights that in the digital world, your writing is your first impression. Clear, structured communication isn't just about following rules; it's about building trust and showing that you value the recipient's time. This task taught me that a well-drafted 5-line email is far more effective than a long, disorganized one.

Social Media Responsible Use Checklist

Category	Do's	Don'ts
Privacy	Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA).	Don't share live location in real-time.

Identity	Use a professional profile picture.	Don't share sensitive data (Aadhaar/OTP).
Content	Fact-check news before resharing.	Don't use unprofessional language.
Safety	Keep personal/public posts separate.	Don't click on suspicious "Prize" links.
Etiquette	Ask permission before tagging friends.	Don't engage with online trolls.

Task 5 Reflection: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

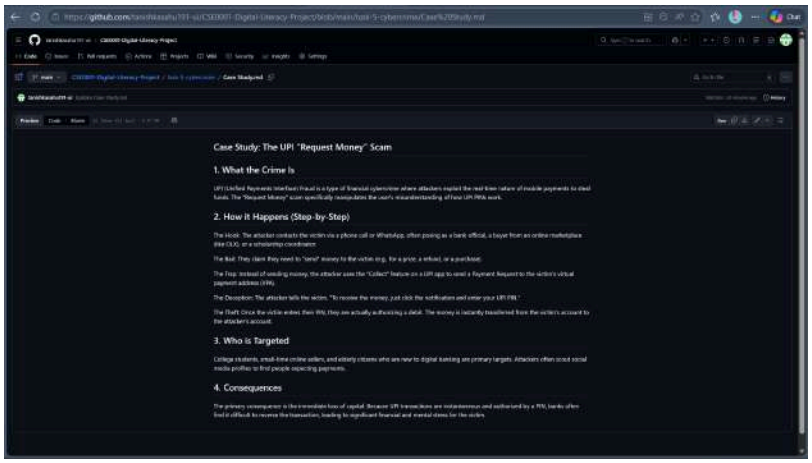
1. The Case Study: UPI "Request Money" Fraud

Scenario: A fictional but realistic case of a student targeted via a "Scholarship Prize" scam.

- **The Crime:** Financial fraud via social engineering on UPI platforms.

- **The Process:** A scammer sends a "Collect Request" to the victim, claiming it is the only way to "receive" a prize. The victim, unaware that a PIN is only for sending money, enters their credentials.
- **The Consequence:** Immediate unauthorized debit of funds and loss of savings.

casestudy.md

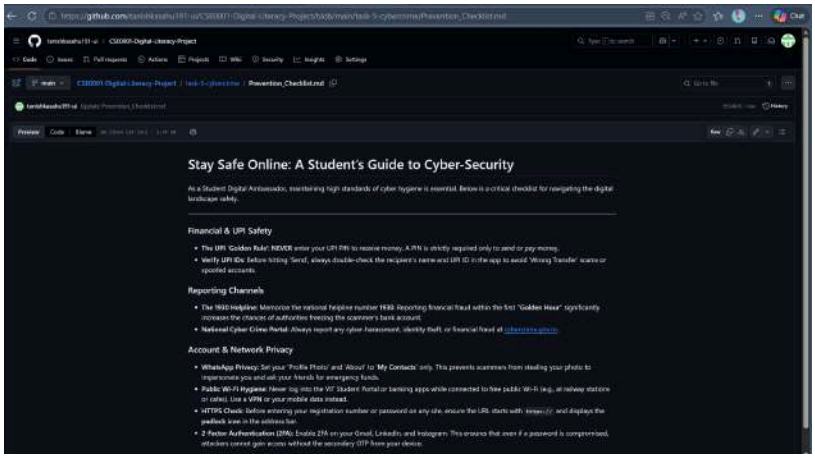


2. Stay Safe Online: 8-Point Checklist

Tip	Actionable Advice
1. UPI PIN Rule	Never enter your PIN to *receive* money.
2. Identity Check	Verify the name and UPI ID of the requester before acting.
3. 2FA Security	Enable Two-Factor Authentication on Gmail and LinkedIn.

4. HTTPS Lock	Only enter data on sites with a padlock icon and https://.
5. Public Wi-Fi	Avoid banking or student portal logins on open networks.
6. App Updates	Keep payment apps and OS updated for security patches.
7. Privacy Settings	Limit WhatsApp profile visibility to "Contacts Only."
8. Reporting	Use **1930** or **cybercrime.gov.in** for immediate help.

Prevention checklist . md



3. Personal Reflection

While researching for Task 5, I was most surprised to learn about the 'Golden Hour' concept associated with the **1930 National Cyber Crime Helpline**. I previously assumed that once a UPI transaction was authorized, the funds were lost forever. Discovering that there is a structured, real-time mechanism to intercept and freeze stolen funds if reported immediately was a major revelation. It highlighted that the speed of the victim's response is just as critical as the bank's security protocols.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is my usage of **Public Wi-Fi networks**. I previously accessed my student portal and emails at cafes without considering the risk of 'Man-in-the-Middle' attacks. I now realize how easily sensitive credentials can be intercepted. From now on, I will strictly use a personal mobile hotspot or a VPN for any task involving passwords or financial information.

Final Project Conclusion

This project has been a transformative experience in building my professional digital identity. From designing accessible infographics to mastering GitHub and understanding cyber-laws, I have gained the essential skills needed to navigate the tech industry safely and professionally. I am now better equipped to contribute to the digital community as a responsible B.Tech student.